## VI What voids the warranty

| Covered — everyday use | At your own risk — voids it |
|---|---|
| Swapping switches · changing keycaps · own cables · remapping keys and layers | Opening the case for any soldering · hardware mods · flashing firmware that bricks the board |

We want you to tinker — that's the point. But the PCB and controllers are assembled and tested by us; taking them apart is where we can't stand behind the build.

## VII Support & service

| | |
|---|---|
| **Warranty** | 1 year, serviced in India. We repair soldering issues and replace controllers under normal use. |
| **Return** | 15 days, no questions — if the layout isn't for you, send it back. |
| **Support** | reactiby@gmail.com |

MODEL: APOLLO58 v1

# Apollo58

Split, column-staggered and fully customisable keyboard

**USER MANUAL**

Please read before you set up your boards.

! READ BEFORE CONNECTING

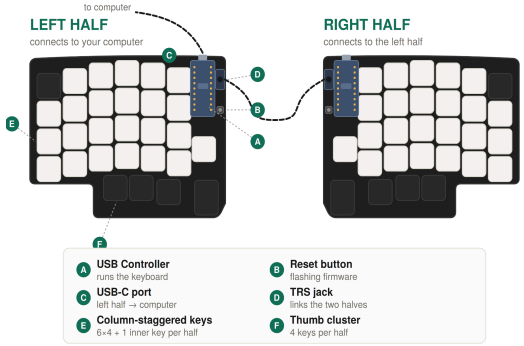
**Never plug or unplug the TRRS cable while the keyboard is powered.** Disconnect USB first. Hot-plugging the TRRS can short and permanently damage the controller.

# I What's what

## In the box

- Travel-cum-Storage Case
- **Left half** — this one connects to your computer
- Right half
- **USB-C cable** (left half → computer)
- **TRRS cable** (links the two halves)
- Keycap puller, spare keycaps and switches
- Silicon feet
- **Desk card** (default layout one side, blank the other)

PARTS & CONNECTIONS




## A deeper clean

- Unplug the keyboard (USB C first, then the TRRS).
- **Pull the caps and switches.** Remove the keycaps and the switches straight up, one at a time (refer previous sections for detailed guide).
- **Brush the plate.** Sweep the exposed plate with a soft dry brush or a dry cotton bud to clear dust from around the sockets. Keep it light — you are dusting, not scrubbing.
- **Wipe the keycaps.** A damp cloth is fine (a drop of mild soap in warm water for stubborn grime). Let them air-dry fully before refitting.
- **Wipe the switches.** Lightly damp cloth on the housings only. Never soak a switch or wet the metal pins; let them dry fully.
- **Reassemble dry.** Refit switches and keycaps only once everything is completely dry — pins straight, press straight down until each clicks.

## Keep moisture off the electronics

- Damp cloth only for parts you have taken off the board. For anything still on the board, dry brush and air only.
- Never let liquid reach the PCB, the hot-swap sockets or the TRRS / USB-C jacks.
- No harsh solvents, acetone or abrasive cleaners — they haze keycaps and can mark the plate finish.

### Swapping switches (hot-swap)

- **Unplug first**; remove the keycap.
- **Grip the switch** with the puller and pull straight up.
- **Check the pins are straight** on the new switch — a bent pin makes a dead key.
- **Press straight down** until it clicks. Don't force it.

REMAPPING KEYS & LAYERS

Scan the QR code on the last page to open the configurator.

## V Maintenance & care

We recommend a brush every two or three weeks and a deeper clean every few months (always unplug the USB cable first).

### Everyday dusting

- Switch the board off or unplug the USB cable first.
- Run a soft, dry brush between the keycaps to lift dust, crumbs and hair.
- Wipe the keycap tops and the case with a barely-damp microfibre cloth, then dry straight away.

## II Getting started

- **Join the halves:** Plug the TRRS cable into the jack on the inner edge of each half. Push until it clicks.
- **Connect to your computer:** Plug the USB-C cable from the left half into a USB port. Both halves light up.
- **Start typing:** Works immediately — no driver or app needed.

! READ BEFORE CONNECTING

**Never plug or unplug the TRRS cable while the keyboard is powered.** Disconnect USB first. Hot-plugging the TRRS can short and permanently damage the controller.

## III Getting used to it

A split, columnar layout is a new motor skill. The first week or two feels slow — that is normal and temporary.

### What to expect

Your typing speed drops sharply at first and returns to normal within one to three weeks of daily practice.

### A simple plan

- **15–20 minutes of focused practice** each day for one to two weeks.
- **Pick a low-stakes day** to go fully split (a weekend or light workday) so you commit instead of switching back and forth.
- **Keep the layout in view.** Use the desk card (default layout one side, blank the other) or the on-screen editor. Pencil any remaps onto the blank side.

### Habits that build muscle memory

- **Accuracy before speed** — slow down; speed returns on its own.
- **Don't look down** — peeking recalls the old map.
- **One hand per half** — never reach across the gap.
- **Use your thumbs** for space, enter, backspace and layer keys.
- **Float your hands** rather than anchoring your wrists.
- We recommend using Apollo58 despite the layout or speed challenges regularly to feel the meaningful upgrade it is, instead of switching with a slab board back and forth.

### Where to practise

Practice on free typing sites (e.g. keybr.com, typ.ing).

### A two-week starter

| Days | Focus |
|---|---|
| 1 | Learn your key map — sit with the layout to learn each key. |
| 1–3 | Bridge layer + 15 mins typing practice. |
| 4–10 | Full base layer; practise with eyes off the keys. Start the numbers / symbol layers. |
| 11–14 | Do real work; add the navigation layer; push speed. |

## IV Make it yours

Switches, keycaps and key mapping are all yours to change — no soldering required.

### Changing keycaps

The board accepts standard MX-style keycaps.

- **Pick a uniform-profile set** (DSA, XDA, MT3). Sculpted sets (Cherry, OEM) won't sit evenly on a column-staggered board.
- **Unplug first** (or switch off) before changing caps (USB C first, then the TRRS).
- **To remove a cap**, hook the puller under two opposite corners and pull straight up — don't rock it.
- **To fit a cap**, line the stem over the cross-stem and press straight down until it clicks.